

Sample Chabad House Report Card

The Chabad House	Shul	Office	Lobby	Simcha Hall	Kitchen
Cleanliness					
Orderliness					
Friendliness					
The Staff	Shliach	Shlucha	Secretary	Bookkeeper	Coordinator
Communication					
Preparedness					
Planning					
Delegation					
Presentability					
Programs & Events	Shiurim	Holiday Events	Shul	Fundraiser	Shabbos
Coordination					
Punctuality					
Attendance					
New Faces					
Toichen					
Finances	Daily Goals	Weekly Goals	Monthly Goals	Annual Goals	Personal
Fundraising					
Budgeting					
Bookkeeping					

House want to produce? How are you going to measure people's connection, the sense of community, their growth in Yiddishkeit?

Rabbi Marcus breaks down the strategy into three stages:

- 1) Building connections
- 2) Building communities
- 3) Moving people up in Yiddishkeit

These are aspects that need to be reported on so that you can measure success against your expectations. So that you can modify programs to continuously meet the needs of your community. Only then can you adequately report on the overall progress of your Chabad House to determine if you are successfully moving in the direction of your vision.

CONCLUSION

The consensus is that leadership is “doing the right things” while management is “doing things right.” Clarifying missions, vision, and objectives

is “doing the right things”, wheres management is a responsible for “doing things right” through strategy and operations.

The Rebbe said the difference between a shliach and an askan is that the askan does things for the community while the shliach becomes part of the community. Every shliach must challenge himself and ask, “Am I fulfilling my potential? How can I be more successful? What’s holding me back? Am I working for the community or am I becoming a part of it?”

If you are failing, make sure you know where you are failing. We can’t solve problems with the same kind of thinking we used when we created them.

On a leadership level each shliach must posses a willingness and desire to evolve as a leader. On the management level, shluchim are under a lot of pressure and don’t have the time, but they must make the time.

With Hashem’s help, the dream is becoming a reality; the time to plan for “the plan” is now. 

COST CUTTING TIPS

Contributing Shluchim: Rabbis Simcha Backman, Yossi Lazaroff, Elchonon Tenenbaum, Chesky Tenenbaum, Sruli Deitsch, Yosef Eisenbach, Mrs. Dini Gurevitz, Mrs. Chana Benjaminson

Whether stationed in a community of five thousand or five hundred thousand, every shliach works to make the most of an often tight budget, stretching every dollar to provide for his community and family alike. There are some simple ways, however, that can make cost cutting easier and more effective, without being too time consuming.

REEVALUATE YOUR BILLS

Rabbi Simcha Backman, Shliach in Glendale, CA and Director of ShluchimExchange, for example, recommends that shluchim reevaluate their personal and commercial mortgages as a way to save money.

“In this economic climate, banks are very open to negotiation,” says Rabbi Backman, who has been personally successful in this area. “Even if they agree to adjust your rate for



SAVE MONEY ONLINE

The following websites also come highly recommended:

Amazon.com/Mom offers members 15% off baby products, including diapers.

Amazon.com/Subscribeandsave offers another 15% off when you request regular deliveries of your purchases.

Dansdeals.com is a general bargain finding site.

Ebates.com offers rebates on members' online purchases.

Kosheronabudget.com advertises daily and weekly kosher deals.

Kolleldeals.com has metzias on everything from convection ovens and pots to keyboards and ladders.

Swagbucks.com offers coupon points for using its search engine.

Moxicopy.com provides free shipping when you print newsletters, cards, stationery, or other items, and even accepts small orders.

Mint.com is free personal finance software to assist you in managing your money, financial planning and budget planning.

Annualcreditreport.com allows you to order a credit report once every twelve months from each of the nationwide consumer credit reporting companies: TransUnion, Equifax, and Experian.

a few years, it can save you a few thousand dollars a month.”

Rabbi Backman also emphasizes the importance of examining your bills, at least every few months. This is because rates and promotions are constantly changing, and it is crucial not only to secure new deals, but also to ensure that companies are not overcharging you.

“Just make sure that there’s nothing out of the ordinary on your bills,” he says. “If you’re overcharged monthly, it makes a big difference. Pay attention to your bills and you can save big money.”

Important areas to review bills include phones, bank statements and credit cards. These types of companies are more likely to add new fees, which can often occur incrementally, or present inadvertent mistakes.

SHOP FOR DISCOUNTS

Rabbi Yossi Lazaroff, Shliach at Texas A&M University, finds cost cutting most effective when purchasing goods.

According to him, bulk discount stores, such as Costco or Sam’s Club, now provide many products that shluchim can use, such as cholov Yisroel cheeses, cold cuts, and even pas Yisroel pizza crusts.

“All you need to do is request these items at your local store and they will carry them for you,” says Rabbi Lazaroff.

Taking advantage of collective buying power with other shluchim, such as discounts with Office Depot, is also a good way to save money.

“Printing at Office Depot ends up being cheaper than doing it at home,” explains Rabbi Lazaroff. “The shluchim discount is automatically applied to your credit card, and you can save over 50 percent on big printing jobs there. I find a lot of good advice with these things on the Shluchim Exchange.”

The newly formed CPN (Chabad Purchasing Network) is bringing this concept to the next level by adding discounts on gas cards, phone systems, insurance, paper goods and many other useful items.

Rabbi Lazaroff also suggests taking

into account the cost of time, not just money. For example, if you pay someone hourly to do the laundry or ironing in your home, you may actually discover that it is less expensive to send your items to a cleaner instead.

NEGOTIATE AND CONSOLIDATE

Rabbi Elchonon Tenenbaum, Shliach in Napa Valley, California, suggests consolidating phones, using voice over IP as a primary phone line, and joining family plans with other shluchim when possible. He emphasizes finding the best deal for cell phone and other plans as a way to save money.

He has also had much success when negotiating with local businesses for a low rate. “I always ask the companies to work with me on price,” says Rabbi Tenenbaum, who finds that businesses will even throw in extra promotions if asked. “They often go down a third in price or more, especially in this economy. In home maintenance, contracted jobs, programs, speakers, really any area, they will work with you to fit a tight budget.”

UTILIZE COUPONS

Rabbi Tenenbaum also uses local coupons to his advantage, such as buying six oil changes for his car in advance. Such a promotion can save some 70 cents to the dollar.

Mrs. Dini Gurevitz, Shlucha in Abington, Pennsylvania, alerts herself to grocery store circulars and children’s store coupons or promotions. The home store Bed, Bath, and Beyond, offers 20 percent off coupons which can be applied even months after a purchase, and boasts an exceptional return and replacement policy.

And **Rabbi Chesky Tenenbaum**, Shliach in Upper Montgomery County, Maryland, suggests purchasing a gas card from the gas station that you use most often. “You can get up to five percent back on every purchase of gas with one of these cards,” says Rabbi Tenenbaum. “And if you qualify, you can get a tax exempt gas card and save over 18 cents a gallon.”

CPN’s negotiations with Exxon Mobil produced a card that can be used at 95% of gas stations nationwide (not

Save Money on Air Conditioning Costs This Summer

BY JEREMY VOHWINNKE, FINANCIAL PLANNER

Summer is approaching, and with the warm weather comes increased cooling costs. While there are a number of different ways you can save money during the summer months, the air conditioner tends to be the biggest energy gorger. Any appliance that uses electricity to alter temperature is generally inefficient by nature. This includes heaters, hot water heaters, refrigerators, and so on. Fortunately, there are some things you can do to help maximize your air conditioning efficiency.



Perform **regular maintenance** on your air conditioning unit. Replace the filter

monthly during the cooling season and have a professional service your system at the beginning of each cooling season.



If you have a central air unit, make sure the **condenser** is located in a shady spot

and has room to dispose of the heated air it removes from your house. Don’t crowd it with shrubs or anything else.



Install a **programmable thermostat** so you can vary the temperature according to when you’re home. Set it for a lower temperature when you’re home. If you’ll be gone for more than a few hours, it makes sense to set the air conditioning at a higher temperature while you’re gone.



Close drapes or shades on the sunny side of your house. The sun has intense

warming effects, and when it is allowed to enter a window without the heat being able to escape, it will act like a greenhouse. Keep as much direct sunlight out as possible to keep your home a few degrees cooler.



Seal up air leaks in your house. Just as drafts can find their way into your house in the winter, hot air does the same thing during the summer. Caulk or seal places where utilities come into your home (plumbing, electricity, dryer vents, etc.). Fill gaps around chimneys and weatherstrip around drafty windows and doors.

Utilize fans as much as possible. If the temperature is just



slightly uncomfortable, consider using an oscillating fan, or ceiling fan if you have one. Just a slight breeze or circulation caused by fans can make it feel a few degrees cooler.



Turn off the lights when not in use. If you have standard incandescent bulbs, they generate a good deal of heat. Having lights on when not necessary just increases the temperature in the house. Consider switching to CFL bulbs, which run cool, and also consume less electricity.

These are just a few of many different ways you can cut down on your cooling costs this summer. If the going gets tough, you can also do so by making a point to spend more time in public air conditioned facilities.

just Exxon). “Exxon has assigned dedicated representatives to help you attain tax exempt status and join the program,” says **Rabbi Sruli Deitsch**, Director of Sales at CPN. “If you already have a gas card and set up your tax documents properly, they will switch you over to this one so you won’t be limited to just one gas company.”

EDIT YOUR SHOPPING LISTS

Mrs. Gurevitz suggests that another way to find yourself with some extra money in your account is to adjust your Shabbos menus to include fewer and less expensive dishes. She recommends paying only with cash if times are tough, and if possible, stocking up on items that you find at a good price. Free shopper’s rewards cards can save you money on your grocery bills as well.

Mrs. Chana Benjaminson, Shlucha in South Coast, Massachusetts, has found that supermarkets frequently restock their produce shelves and place produce that is still in great shape on the half-off sale rack. Local farms or small produce stores often offer great prices if you buy in bulk and may even deliver to your home.

Becoming familiar with the state and local programs that the government has to offer can be a big assistance as well.

FIND VOLUNTEERS

Rabbi Yosef Eisenbach, Shliach in Northwest Connecticut, recommends finding volunteers from your community to provide services. The key is to determine what needs to be done and find people who are appropriate for the job.

Volunteers can be useful in some of

the following areas:

- Babysitting
- Organization of your home or office
- Musical or other performance for your events
- Home repair or maintenance
- Gardening
- Photography and videography
- Documenting Chabad activities via scrapbooking or graphic design.

Whether the one-time savings are large or small, the cumulative worth does add up. Take a few moments to reevaluate your bills, shop for discounts, negotiate and consolidate, utilize coupons, edit your shopping lists, find volunteers, and look for ways to save money online. Even if you’re not tight with money right now, it doesn’t hurt to put a few extra coins in the bank, does it? 

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